History Week 4: the Black Death (written)

Ember · A 12-mark question in AQA's format · about 20 minutes Date: _____

Skill: So What? After every Evidence sentence, write one more sentence: what does this show people believed, feared or wanted? Point back at the evidence. Evidence must come from your notes or the reference page below.

Reference page (for checking claims, not for copying)

- Most people believed the Black Death (1348–49) was sent by God as a punishment for sin. Responses included prayer, processions and pilgrimage.
- Flagellants whipped themselves in public to show God they were sorry. They were mostly in mainland Europe; a group came to London in 1349, but the movement did not catch on in England.
- Many people believed disease spread through **miasma**: bad air and foul smells from rotting matter. People carried sweet-smelling herbs and flowers to protect themselves, and lit fires to clean the air.
- In 1349 King Edward III ordered the Mayor of London to clear the filth from the streets, because of the foul smell it gave off.
- Doctors followed the theory of the four humours: bleeding and purging to rebalance the body.

Plan (5 min): at least one row per bullet point

Bullet point	Evidence (from my notes)	So what? What did it show they believed?	Claim check: supported / check / source needed
Religious beliefs			
Religious beliefs			
Ideas about bad air			
Ideas about bad air			

[12 marks]

Which of the following was the more important reason why people in England responded to the Black Death in the ways that they did:

- religious beliefs
- ideas about bad air (miasma)?

Explain your answer with reference to both bullet points.

Self-check (5 min)

□ I wrote about both bullet points.

□ Every Evidence sentence has a So What after it, and each So What points back at its evidence.

□ My claims are in my notes or the reference page (I filled in the claim check column).

□ No hindsight, and no modern labels.

□ My last paragraph says which reason was more important, and why.

□ Reflection: which So What was easiest to write? Which claim was hardest to back up? What would my first sentence say now?

How AQA marks a 12-mark "Which was the more important reason" question (levels)

- **Level 4 (10–12): complex explanation of both bullets leading to a sustained judgement.** Explains how the reasons are related, supported by accurate and detailed knowledge.
- **Level 3 (7–9): developed explanation of both bullets.** Extended reasoning, supported by a range of accurate knowledge.
- **Level 2 (4–6): simple explanation of bullet(s).** Simple reasoning, supported by specific knowledge.
- **Level 1 (1–3): basic explanation of one or both bullets.** General, limited knowledge.

Your So Whats are the step from Level 2 to Level 3. A Level 4 answer links the two bullets: for example, many people believed God sent the bad air, so the two ideas worked together. My level: _____

Question written for Ember in the format of AQA GCSE History 8145 Paper 1 Question 6 (12 marks). Level headings from AQA's published mark schemes, used for private practice.